

Newborn Awake Window Tracker

0 – 12 WEEKS · MINUTE-BY-MINUTE PRECISION

"The difference between overtired and on-time is 15 minutes."

- ✓ Minute-precision awake window tables by age band
- ✓ Feed–Wake–Sleep cycle daily logs (6 feeds/day)
- ✓ Sleep cue spotter with Green / Yellow / Red status
- ✓ Environment checklist — run it every single sleep
- ✓ Weekly pattern analysis with notes
- ✓ Timer prompt cards for every age band

[Quick-Start Guide](#)

[Week 1 Log](#)

[Reference Tables](#)

Sleep, Baby, Please. · Six & Thriving

GETTING STARTED

Quick-Start: Use This Tracker Tonight

Five things to do before you put baby down for the next sleep.

1

Find your baby's age band

Flip to the Awake Window Reference (page 4). Find your exact week. Write that window's start-timer number on a sticky note. Put it on your phone.

2

Set a countdown timer

The moment baby's eyes open from the last sleep — start the timer. Begin wind-down 10–15 min before the window closes. No exceptions.

3

Spot the GREEN cues — not the red

Green = quiet, still, gaze drifting. That is your go-signal. Do not wait for yawning. By the yawn, you're already late.

4

Check the environment before every transfer

Blackout? White noise running? Temp right? All LEDs dark? Use the Environment Checklist on every single transfer.

5

Log it — every time

Wake time, feed time, cues spotted, how long to settle. Patterns emerge by day 3. Patterns tell you what works.

"Feed–Wake–Sleep is a loop, not a ladder. Just keep looping."

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BABY PROFILE

Your Newborn's Profile

Fill this in once. Reference it to track weekly progress.

IDENTITY

Baby's name

Date of birth

Due date (EDD)

Adjusted age note

Birth weight

Current weight

CURRENT STAGE

Current week (0–12)

Current awake window

Avg. feeds per day

Longest sleep stretch

Paed / midwife name

Notes

EARLY SLEEP PERSONALITY (circle your gut sense now — revisit at week 8)

Select one:



The Snacker



The Sensitive Soul



The Night Owl



The Catnapper



The Overthinker



The Party Animal

First-week observations & patterns noticed

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REFERENCE

Awake Window Reference — 0 to 12 Weeks

Find your week. Set your timer. Begin wind-down 10–15 min before the window closes.

Age Band	Window	Timer Cue	Notes / Key Risk
0–2 weeks	45 min	Start wind-down at 30 min. No mercy.	Strictly follow feed-wake-sleep. No routine yet. Survival mode is ok.
2–4 weeks	45–60 min	Start at 35 min. Watch gaze unfocus.	Watch for first yawn — that's your signal. Start wind-down immediately.
4–6 weeks	60–75 min	Start at 45 min. First yawn = go time.	Circadian rhythm beginning. Distinguish day/night with light cues.
6–8 weeks	75–90 min	Start at 60 min. Peak fuss week — trust the clock.	Fussiest peak week. More awake time doesn't mean later bedtime.
8–10 weeks	75–90 min	Start at 65 min. Social smiling extends windows — resist.	Social smiles emerging. Don't let engagement push past window.
10–12 weeks	90 min	Start at 75 min. 90 min is hard ceiling.	Melatonin production increasing. Early bedtime locks in rhythm.

PRECISION MATTERS

A 10-minute overshoot triggers cortisol. A baby who has crossed the window will fight sleep harder and wake earlier. The window is not a suggestion.

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Sleep Cue Spotter — Green / Yellow / Red

By the time you see yellow, wind-down should already be happening.

GREEN — Go Now

- Quieting down, stilling movements
- Gaze becomes unfocused or drifting
- Reduced interest in toys/faces
- Slowing arm and leg movements

Start wind-down NOW. Don't wait.

YELLOW — Hurry Up

- Single yawn (not yet repeated)
- Ear tugging or hair pulling
- Eyes beginning to glaze
- Slightly fussy or whimpery

Begin transfer to crib immediately.

RED — Overtired

- Repeated yawning — cortisol spike likely
- Arching back, pulling away
- Inconsolable crying
- Second wind — suddenly awake again

Extra soothing needed. Longer settle ahead.

FEED-WAKE-SLEEP TIPS

- Feed → short awake window → sleep. Repeat. That's it.
- Don't skip the awake window entirely — even 20 min of gentle stimulation helps.
- Feed does NOT have to end the awake window — burp, change, brief play first.
- If baby falls asleep mid-feed: gentle toe-tickle, chin rub, nappy change to wake.
- Cluster feeding in the evening is normal — not a sign of low supply.

Quick log — what cue triggered this transfer?

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ENVIRONMENT

Environment Checklist — Every Single Transfer

Run this before every crib put-down. Takes 20 seconds. Changes everything.

CONFIRM EVERY ITEM BEFORE TRANSFER — not after. Fix issues before the window closes.

☐

Room Temperature

68–72°F / 20–22°C

Observation / actual reading:

☐

True Blackout

Cannot see hand in front of face

Observation / actual reading:

☐

White Noise

60–65 dB — not inside the crib

Observation / actual reading:

☐

All LEDs Covered

Electrical tape on all glowing indicators

Observation / actual reading:

☐

Sleep Surface

Firm, flat, back-only — no incline

Observation / actual reading:

☐

Baby's Clothing

Chest warm but not sweaty — check tog

Observation / actual reading:

TEMPERATURE LOG — Running Record

Date / Time

Room Temp

Baby Temp Feel

Clothing Tog

Action Taken

"True blackout means you cannot see your hand in front of your face."

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WEEK 1

Week 1 · Daily Awake Window Log

Days 1 – 4 · Log every feed, wake time, sleep time, and cue spotted.

DAY 1

Date: Baby age (weeks): Awake window used (min): Cues spotted:

Wake

Feed 1

Feed 2

Feed 3

Bedtime

Night wake

Settle time (min):

Night waking count:

Notes / what worked:

DAY 2

Date: Baby age (weeks): Awake window used (min): Cues spotted:

Wake

Feed 1

Feed 2

Feed 3

Bedtime

Night wake

Settle time (min):

Night waking count:

Notes / what worked:

DAY 3

Date: Baby age (weeks): Awake window used (min): Cues spotted:

Wake

Feed 1

Feed 2

Feed 3

Bedtime

Night wake

Settle time (min):

Night waking count:

Notes / what worked:

DAY 4

Date: Baby age (weeks): Awake window used (min): Cues spotted:

Wake

Feed 1

Feed 2

Feed 3

Bedtime

Night wake

Settle time (min):

Night waking count:

Notes / what worked:

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WEEK 1

Week 1 · Daily Awake Window Log

Days 5 – 7 · Log every feed, wake time, sleep time, and cue spotted.

DAY 5

Date:

Baby age (weeks):

Awake window used (min):

Cues spotted:

Wake

Feed 1

Feed 2

Feed 3

Bedtime

Night wake

Settle time (min):

Night waking count:

Notes / what worked:

DAY 6

Date:

Baby age (weeks):

Awake window used (min):

Cues spotted:

Wake

Feed 1

Feed 2

Feed 3

Bedtime

Night wake

Settle time (min):

Night waking count:

Notes / what worked:

DAY 7

Date:

Baby age (weeks):

Awake window used (min):

Cues spotted:

Wake

Feed 1

Feed 2

Feed 3

Bedtime

Night wake

Settle time (min):

Night waking count:

Notes / what worked:

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WEEK 1

Week 1 • Weekly Reflection & Pattern Analysis

Five minutes of honest review. This is where progress gets sharper.

SLEEP STATS — WEEK AT A GLANCE

Avg. awake window used (min)

Avg. time to settle (min)

Night wakings (avg/night)

Longest sleep stretch (hrs)

Best night — day #

Hardest night — day #

What cue am I consistently catching first?

Green, yellow, or red — and is it getting earlier?

Which awake window felt most accurate this week?

Note the specific minute count that worked best.

What environment fix made the biggest difference?

Identify the single change with the biggest impact.

What will I do differently next week?

One specific, actionable change only.

"The difference between overtired and on-time is 15 minutes."

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WEEK 2

Week 2 · Daily Awake Window Log

Days 1 – 4 · Log every feed, wake time, sleep time, and cue spotted.

DAY 1

Date: Baby age (weeks): Awake window used (min): Cues spotted:

Wake

Feed 1

Feed 2

Feed 3

Bedtime

Night wake

Settle time (min):

Night waking count:

Notes / what worked:

DAY 2

Date: Baby age (weeks): Awake window used (min): Cues spotted:

Wake

Feed 1

Feed 2

Feed 3

Bedtime

Night wake

Settle time (min):

Night waking count:

Notes / what worked:

DAY 3

Date: Baby age (weeks): Awake window used (min): Cues spotted:

Wake

Feed 1

Feed 2

Feed 3

Bedtime

Night wake

Settle time (min):

Night waking count:

Notes / what worked:

DAY 4

Date: Baby age (weeks): Awake window used (min): Cues spotted:

Wake

Feed 1

Feed 2

Feed 3

Bedtime

Night wake

Settle time (min):

Night waking count:

Notes / what worked:

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Night wake

Settle time (min):

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Notes / what worked:

DAY 6

Date:

Baby age (weeks):

Awake window used (min):

Cues spotted:

Wake

Feed 1

Feed 2

Feed 3

Bedtime

Night wake

Settle time (min):

Night waking count:

Notes / what worked:

DAY 7

Date:

Baby age (weeks):

Awake window used (min):

Cues spotted:

Wake

Feed 1

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"Every crib transfer is a practice run. You will get faster."

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WEEK 3

Week 3 · Daily Awake Window Log

Days 1 – 4 · Log every feed, wake time, sleep time, and cue spotted.

DAY 1

Date: Baby age (weeks): Awake window used (min): Cues spotted:

Wake

Feed 1

Feed 2

Feed 3

Bedtime

Night wake

Settle time (min):

Night waking count:

Notes / what worked:

DAY 2

Date: Baby age (weeks): Awake window used (min): Cues spotted:

Wake

Feed 1

Feed 2

Feed 3

Bedtime

Night wake

Settle time (min):

Night waking count:

Notes / what worked:

DAY 3

Date: Baby age (weeks): Awake window used (min): Cues spotted:

Wake

Feed 1

Feed 2

Feed 3

Bedtime

Night wake

Settle time (min):

Night waking count:

Notes / what worked:

DAY 4

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Feed 3

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Night wake

Settle time (min):

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Notes / what worked:

DAY 6

Date:

Baby age (weeks):

Awake window used (min):

Cues spotted:

Wake

Feed 1

Feed 2

Feed 3

Bedtime

Night wake

Settle time (min):

Night waking count:

Notes / what worked:

DAY 7

Date:

Baby age (weeks):

Awake window used (min):

Cues spotted:

Wake

Feed 1

Feed 2

Feed 3

Bedtime

Night wake

Settle time (min):

Night waking count:

Notes / what worked:

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PROGRESS

Master Pattern Analysis — Weeks 1 – 3

Compare across weeks. The trend line matters more than any single night.

Metric	Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Trend / Change
Avg awake window (min)				
Avg settle time (min)				
Night wakings / night				
Longest sleep stretch				
First cue caught (G/Y/R)				

MILESTONES SPOTTED

First time caught GREEN cue

First 3-hour sleep stretch

First time settled drowsy-awake

First predictable window

Biggest win across 3 weeks:

Primary target heading into next stage:

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Timer Prompt Cards — Cut Out & Keep

One card per age band. Start timer at wake. Begin wind-down at the cue time.

0–2 wks

35–45 min

AWAKE WINDOW

Start wind-down at 30 min. No mercy.

This session start time:

2–4 wks

40–55 min

AWAKE WINDOW

Start at 35 min. Watch gaze unfocus.

This session start time:

4–6 wks

50–70 min

AWAKE WINDOW

Start at 45 min. First yawn = go time.

This session start time:

6–8 wks

65–85 min

AWAKE WINDOW

Start at 60 min. Peak fuss week — trust the clock.

This session start time:

8–10 wks

70–85 min

AWAKE WINDOW

Start at 65 min. Social smiling extends windows — resist.

This session start time:

10–12 wks

80–90 min

AWAKE WINDOW

Start at 75 min. 90 min is hard ceiling.

This session start time:

Print this page, cut along the card edges, and tape the relevant card to your nursing chair / crib rail.
Switch to the next card the moment baby crosses into the next age band.

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Safe Sleep Checklist — Nightly Non-Negotiables

AAP-aligned. Run through this every night until it is muscle memory.

The Sleep Surface

- ☐ Firm, flat mattress — no incline, wedge, or pillow-top
- ☐ Fitted sheet only — no blankets, bumpers, pillows, positioners
- ☐ Baby on their back — every sleep, every time
- ☐ Sleep sack used — correct tog for room temperature
- ☐ Sleep space is crib / bassinet / play yard only

The Room

- ☐ Room temperature 68–72°F / 20–22°C confirmed
- ☐ True blackout achieved
- ☐ White noise running — NOT inside the crib
- ☐ All monitor and device LEDs covered
- ☐ No nightlight, or red-spectrum only

WHEN TO CALL YOUR PEDIATRICIAN: fever during sleep training · breathing irregularity · weight-gain concern · any doubt about

Safe sleep is always the first priority — not the method.

Notes / anything to flag tonight: